



More than 200 million years ago, huge forests of ginkgos covered the land. Now, wild ginkgos only live in a small area of China, but in all that time they have barely changed. Sometimes they are called “living fossils”. Their fan-shaped leaves are unlike those of any other trees on Earth today. In autumn, the leaves turn sunshine yellow before falling off.

Ginkgos are unusual as they are either male or female, more like an animal than a plant, and they don't have flowers. Instead, female trees have sticky shoots that catch the pollen made by male trees as it drifts on the wind. The fruit that grows on the female trees smells disgusting – a bit like sick!

